

English Grammar Reference: Adjectives

Educational Series

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1 Definition

An **Adjective** is a word that describes or modifies a noun or a pronoun. It adds more information about the size, shape, age, color, origin, or material of an object.

2 Classification of Adjectives

- **Adjectives of Quality:** Describe the kind or quality of a person or thing (e.g., *brave* soldier, *beautiful* day).
- **Adjectives of Quantity:** Indicate how much of a thing is meant (e.g., *some* milk, *much* patience). Use with uncountable nouns.
- **Adjectives of Number:** Indicate how many persons or things are meant (e.g., *five* apples, *several* mistakes). Use with countable nouns.
- **Demonstrative Adjectives:** Point out which person or thing is meant (e.g., *this* car, *those* hills).
- **Interrogative Adjectives:** Used with nouns to ask questions (e.g., *whose* pen, *which* way).
- **Possessive Adjectives:** Show ownership (e.g., *my* house, *their* ideas).

3 Degrees of Comparison

Adjectives change in form to show comparison.

Positive	Comparative	Superlative
Tall	Taller	Tallest
Happy	Happier	Happiest
Beautiful	More beautiful	Most beautiful
Good	Better	Best
Bad	Worse	Worst

4 Order of Adjectives

When multiple adjectives are used before a noun, they usually follow a specific order:

1. **Opinion** (pretty, expensive)

2. **Size** (large, tiny)
3. **Age** (old, antique)
4. **Shape** (round, square)
5. **Color** (blue, reddish)
6. **Origin** (Indian, French)
7. **Material** (wooden, silk)
8. **Purpose** (sleeping bag, walking stick)

5 Important Rules

- **The + Superlative:** Always use "the" before a superlative adjective (e.g., *The tallest building*).
- **Double Comparatives:** Avoid using two comparative forms together (Incorrect: *more taller*; Correct: *taller*).
- **Elder vs. Older:** "Elder" is used for members of the same family; "Older" is used for persons or things generally.
- **Few vs. Little:** "Few" is for countable nouns; "Little" is for uncountable nouns.

6 Common Errors

- **Incorrect:** She is the most cleverest girl.
- **Correct:** She is the **cleverest** girl.
- **Incorrect:** I have a little friends.
- **Correct:** I have **a few** friends.